

HDip/Cert in Computer Science

Progression Pathways



Department of Computing and Mathematics

15/12/2025

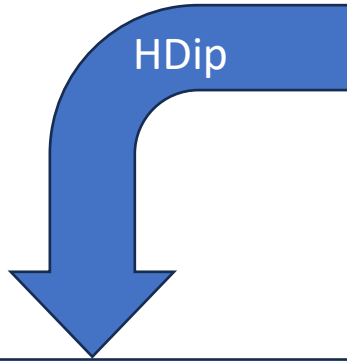


setu.ie
INSPIRING FUTURES

What are the options at SETU once I finish the Cert?

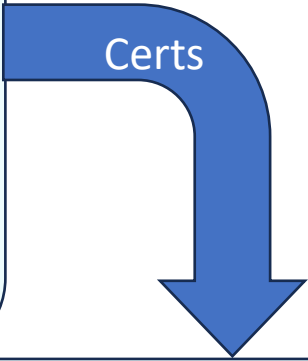
1. Direct Entry onto the Higher Diploma in Computer Science
2. Specialism Certificate
3. I'm good thanks – Slán!







Cert in Computer Science:
Results confirmed 5th June



HDip in Computer Science

Entry to Year 2
Apply via SETU Website
Fee €3500 (Y2 Entry)



Streams

**AI & Machine Learning**

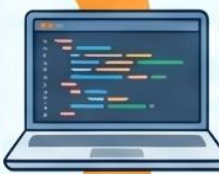
**Software Engineering**

**Project/Industry Pathways
(Placement)**

Specialism Certificates

**AI & Machine Learning**
Springboard+ funded
Focusing on model development, data handling, and infrastructure.

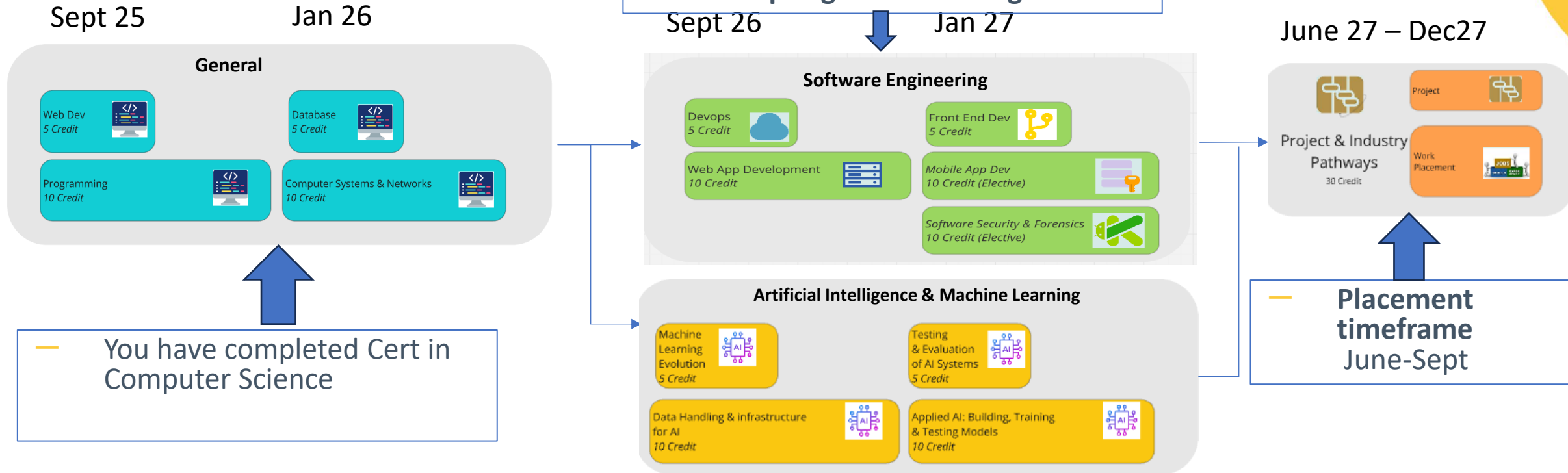
Core Focus Areas: ML Evolution, Data Infrastructure	Key Electives / Projects: Building Models, Applied AI Project
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**Software Engineering**
Self-funded
Route covering AI-augmented development, DevOps, and modern full-stack practices.

Core Focus Areas: Web Apps, DevOps, Front End	Key Electives / Projects: Mobile App Dev or Software Security
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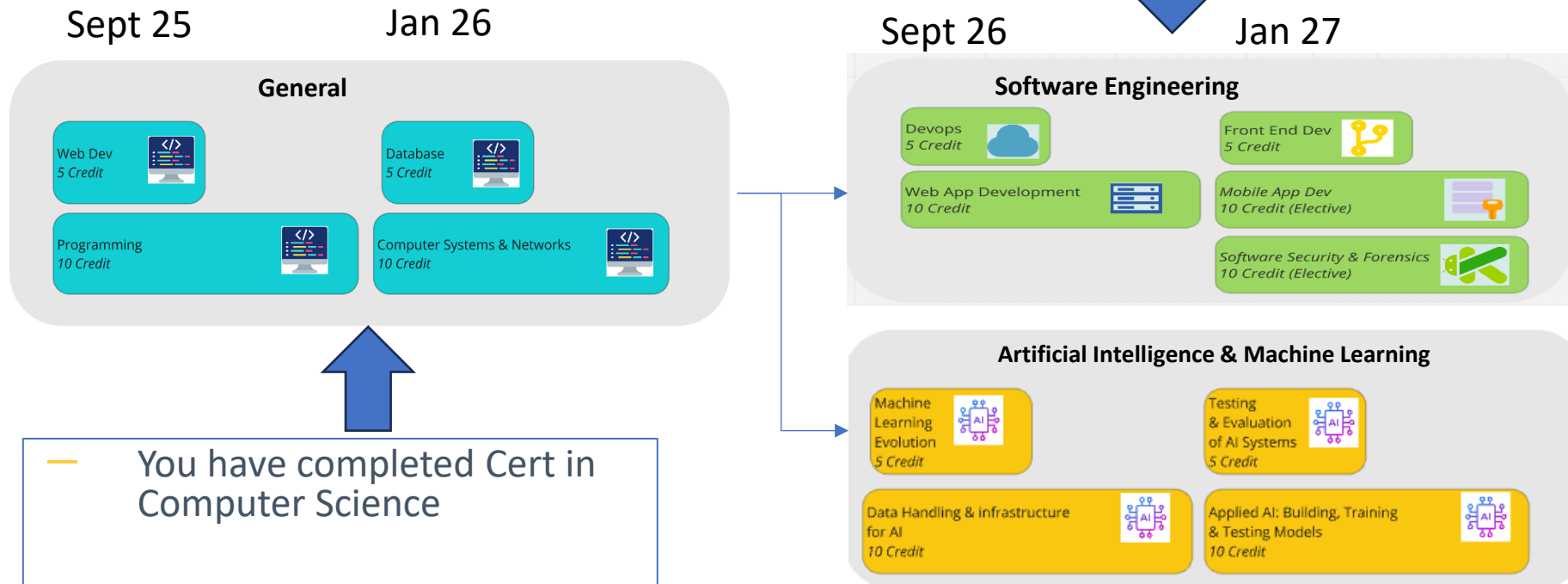
1. Direct Entry onto the Higher Diploma in Computer Science

- Advanced Entry to HDip from Cert
- No Springboard Funding



2. Cert in Computer Science: Specialism Cert Progression

- No Springboard Funding for Soft Eng Cert
- Springboard funding for AI/ML Cert
- No Project/Placement



Application Process: HDip Entry



- Applicants must apply via HDip in Comp Sci page on the SETU Website
- Can apply once grades confirmed at Course Board on June 5th
- Application will be processed by HDip team
- Fees: €3500

Application Process: Certificate in AI and Machine Learning



Springboard+

Springboard+ is a Government initiative offering degree, and masters level leading to qualifications the economy. These areas include ICT, engineering many others

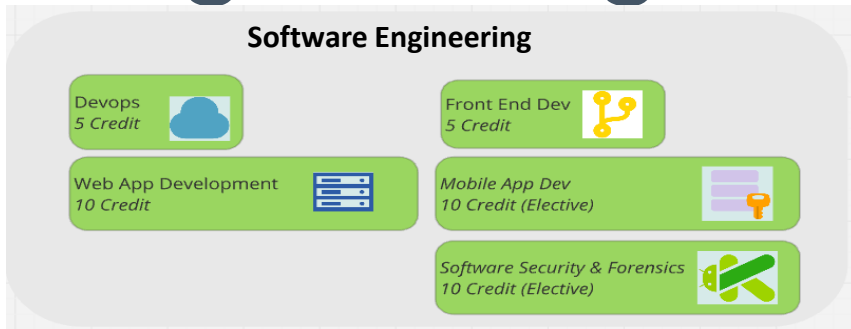
1. Springboard Funded

- If eligible, apply via Springboard+ Website
- Funded in same way as Certificate in Computer Science
- Can progress onto HDip once complete

2. Direct Entry(not Springboard Eligible)

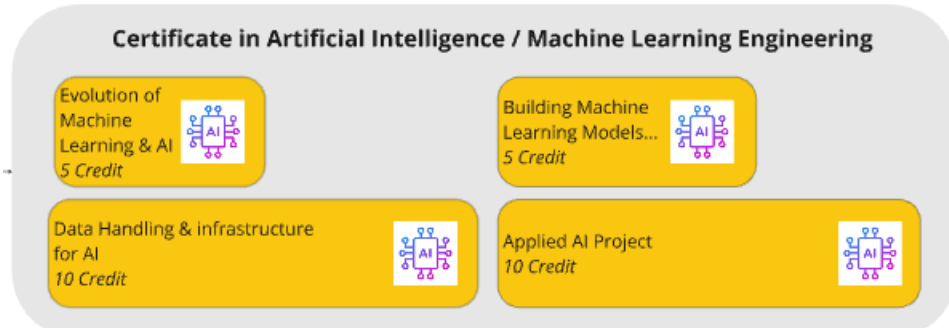
- Apply via SETU Website
- Fees 2500

Cert in Software Engineering



- **Stage 2 of the existing HDip**, retaining core modules but redesigned to integrate AI tools, techniques, and industry practices.
- **Strong industry alignment**, with continuous monitoring of trends and guidance from core industry partners.
- **AI-augmented development**
- Emphasis on developer expertise and judgement
- **Practical curriculum** covering modern full-stack, cloud, microservices, testing, DevOps, and mobile development, reflecting major changes of the last 5 years.
- **Elective Choice:** Mobile App Dev OR Software Security & Forensics in Sem 2

Cert in AI and Machine Learning



- **Hands-on focus** on AI model development, data handling, ML infrastructure, and performance optimisation
- **Industry-aligned curriculum** addressing real-world AI/ML engineering needs across sectors
- **Rigorous, practical learning experience** designed for workplace relevance
- **Supports upskilling and reskilling** into high-demand AI engineering roles